Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification

# CHAPTER I

# THE PROBLEM AND ITS BACKGROUND

This chapter presents the background and related literature of the study entitled “Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification.” It also presents the significance of the study, the statement of the problem, and the scope and limitations of the system.

## 1.1 Introduction

Property management involves maintaining tenant records, managing utility bills, computing charges, monitoring payment status, and providing billing information to tenants. These activities require the organized handling of property records, tenant information, billing documents, and other administrative records. Cammarata (2023) discusses the importance of records and information management in real-estate operations, while Teo et al. (2024) examine property-management functions and services. When property managers handle these activities through separate or manual methods, organizing information and maintaining consistent work processes can become more difficult.

To support these activities, digital approaches provide a way to centralize property information and organize regular management tasks. Property Technology (PropTech) refers to the use of digital technologies in real-estate and property-management activities. Siniak et al. (2020) discuss the role of PropTech in changing real-estate operations and services, while Oyetunji et al. (2025) examine digital solutions for streamlining property-management operations in affordable-housing communities. Their discussion highlights how digital tools may support routine management activities, resource allocation, and tenant interaction, although the study also notes barriers such as financial constraints, infrastructure gaps, and resistance to change. Overall, this literature shows how digital technologies support property and housing-management activities and provides a basis for using centralized systems to organize property information and management processes.

One important area in property management is billing. Utility billing requires information from billing documents before charges can be processed, including amounts, dates, billing periods, providers, and account or reference identifiers. Optical Character Recognition (OCR) provides a way to extract text and relevant information from supported documents such as receipts and invoices (Kumar et al., 2020). Saout et al. (2024) discuss invoice-data extraction as a process involving document digitization, OCR, information extraction, and recognition of document structures. Mohan (2023) also presents a staged pipeline for extracting key-value information from commercial invoices. Overall, these studies support the use of OCR and document-processing methods to extract and organize information from billing documents for later processing.

After billing information is extracted, it still needs to be validated, classified, and processed according to defined billing conditions. Rule-based processing uses predefined conditions and logical rules to support structured operational decisions and information handling. Jiménez and Corchuelo (2022) discuss business-rule engines that represent and execute operational decisions in a structured way. In relation to process automation, Bédard et al. (2024) present a rule-based method that analyzes decision logic and classifies business processes according to their suitability for robotic process automation. These ideas are relevant to a billing workflow in which validation, classification, calculation, and exception-handling conditions are defined in advance. The reviewed literature provides a basis for combining OCR, rule-based processing, and notification technologies in a billing workflow for smaller residential property-management settings.

Based on these ideas, the study proposes a web-based workflow that helps property managers organize billing information and allows tenants to view their bills and history. The system receives supported utility-bill emails and documents, extracts available information through text parsing or OCR, and uses predefined rules to process valid records. Staff investigates records that require review, while the Manager handles decisions requiring financial authority. In this study, "intelligent" refers to OCR-assisted extraction and rule-based processing rather than autonomous decision-making. The workflow separates Manager-confirmed rent payments from personal utility

tracking and provides permitted Web Push alerts and supplementary rent email notifications that direct tenants to the authenticated portal.

## 1.2 Review of Related Literature

### Digital Property Management and PropTech

Digital property management increasingly relies on technology to organize property details, management activities, billing data, and related services. Several studies have examined this shift from different perspectives: Teo et al. (2024) discuss technology and digitalization in property-management functions and service delivery, while Ding and Sun (2024) review technology innovations in housing management. In this context, PropTech refers to the use of digital technologies in the real estate and property-management sector. Siniak et al. (2020) examine the impact of PropTech on real estate industry growth, Saputra et al. (2023) review digital transformation trends in the property-management industry, and Al-haimi et al. (2025) synthesize the technologies, benefits, and challenges associated with digital transformation in real estate. In addition, Cammarata (2023) discusses the importance of records and information management in managing risks during real-estate changes. Overall, this literature supports the relevance of centralized digital tools for property information and administrative processes. Building on this literature, the present study proposes a centralized web-based workflow that organizes property, unit, tenant, utility, billing, payment, exception, and receipt information for selected boarding houses and residential apartments.

### OCR and Billing Document Extraction

Within property-management operations, billing is one area where digital processing can support routine administrative work. Billing documents contain information such as amounts, dates, billing periods, providers, and account or reference identifiers. Kumar et al. (2020) examine the extraction of information from bill receipts using Optical Character Recognition (OCR), while Saout et al. (2024) provide an overview of invoice-data extraction involving document digitization, OCR, information extraction, and document-structure recognition. Similarly, Mohan (2023) presents an

end-to-end pipeline for custom key-value extraction from commercial invoices. However, extracting information from a billing document is only the first stage of billing processing. In the proposed system, readable text from supported billing emails and digitally generated PDFs is extracted directly, while clear bill images undergo OCR. After extraction, the information undergoes validation before billing processing. Records that do not meet the required validation conditions are sent to the Exception Queue for Staff investigation and, when required, Manager decisions. Thus, text extraction and OCR provide information for subsequent checks rather than a guarantee that every extracted value is accurate. The OCR component may employ machine-learning-based text-recognition technology to convert visible characters and document text into machine-readable output. However, the proposed system does not use OCR output or machine-learning recognition to determine billing validity, classify payment status, compute charges, or make property-management decisions.

Rule-Based Billing Processing

Once billing information has been extracted, it must be checked and processed according to defined conditions. Rule-based processing uses explicit conditions and decision rules to classify, validate, and route information. Wu et al. (2022) demonstrate the use of rule-based information extraction to organize domain-specific information, while Jiménez and Corchuelo (2022) discuss business-rule engines for representing and executing operational decisions in a structured manner. Extending this idea to process automation, Bédard et al. (2024) present a rule-based method that analyzes decision logic and classifies business processes according to their suitability for robotic process automation, while Kim et al. (2011) examine proactive exception handling in business processes. These studies support the use of predefined and traceable conditions to determine whether a record proceeds through normal processing or requires additional review. Applying these principles, the proposed system uses defined rules for billing validation, provider and account/reference mapping, duplicate detection, and identifying individual or shared billing arrangements. Records that do not meet the defined conditions are sent to the Exception Queue for Staff investigation and, when required, Manager decisions. These rules, together with the

separation between Tenant-reported rent and Manager-confirmed rent status, are system requirements rather than findings established by the cited studies. Digital rent receipts are created only after Manager confirmation. Personal utility tracking remains separate and does not establish provider settlement.

### Shared Utility Billing and Cost Allocation

Shared utility billing presents a related issue because a single charge may need to be allocated among several occupants. Levinson and Niemann (2004) examine apartment energy use when landlords pay for utilities, while Mayr and Souza (2025) discuss coordination and incentive issues associated with shared heating costs. These studies provide context for understanding cost responsibility and consumption incentives in shared-utility arrangements. Nevertheless, they do not establish one universal allocation formula for rental properties or determine how the proposed system should calculate individual tenant charges. For this reason, the proposed system treats the allocation method as a defined system requirement rather than as a formula established by the reviewed literature. For shared occupancy, charges are split equally among eligible tenants in a Manager-configured group. The billing requirements also include reconciliation controls so that allocated charges equal the source billing amount. The allocation formula, rounding procedure, and reconciliation method are described in the succeeding chapters and will be tested during system evaluation.

### Web Push, Rent Email Notifications, and Secure Notification Delivery

After a billing record is finalized, tenants need to be informed that their billing information is available. The World Wide Web Consortium (2024) describes the Push API, including push services and user subscriptions. The World Wide Web Consortium (2022) also explains the role of service workers in handling web events in the background when they are included in the system implementation. Because Web Push involves browser subscriptions and authorization, security must also be considered. Carboneri et al. (2023) examine Web Push implementations in the wild and identify security concerns involving push subscriptions and authorization. In the proposed

system, Web Push Notifications serve as billing alerts that direct tenants to the authenticated web portal, where complete billing information is available. However, Web Push does not confirm payment, prove that payment occurred, or show whether the tenant read the notification. Tenant payment reporting therefore remains separate from Manager confirmation.

Email provides an additional channel for rent-related alerts. Klensin (2008) describes Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP) as a protocol for transporting electronic mail. Moore and Newman (2018) explain the use of Transport Layer Security (TLS) to protect email submission and access connections. These standards provide a technical basis for supplementary rent email notifications in the proposed system. Emails will inform tenants of rent billing updates, eligible reminders, and Manager-confirmed rent payments, and will direct them to the authenticated portal. Sending attempts and available acceptance or failure results will be recorded. Email-server acceptance will not prove inbox delivery or readership, and sending an alert will not change rent payment status.

Iterative Software Development

Because the proposed system contains several connected functions, its development requires an organized and adaptable process. Iterative software development divides development into repeated cycles of building, reviewing, receiving feedback, and improving. Larman and Basili (2003) explain the development of iterative and incremental approaches, in which software is developed progressively through repeated cycles. Inayat et al. (2015) emphasize stakeholder involvement, communication, and requirements refinement in iterative requirements engineering, while Rasheed et al. (2021) identify challenges involving changing requirements, stakeholder participation, documentation, and communication in Agile software development. These studies support the use of Iterative Software Development Methodology in the present study. Although the literature supports this approach, the actual quality and performance of the proposed system will be determined through implementation, testing, user feedback, and evaluation.

Software Quality Evaluation and Security

To evaluate the proposed system systematically, the study requires defined software-quality criteria. ISO/IEC 25010:2023 provides a product-quality model for systems and software quality requirements and evaluation (International Organization for Standardization, 2023). Guided by this model, the study will evaluate five quality characteristics: Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Interaction Capability, Reliability, and Security. These characteristics provide a basis for examining whether the system performs its intended functions, performs efficiently, supports user interaction, operates consistently, and protects information. Security is particularly important because the system handles tenant and billing information. Republic Act No. 10173, or the Data Privacy Act of 2012, requires organizations that process personal information to use reasonable and appropriate measures to protect it (Republic of the Philippines, 2012). The National Privacy Commission (2016) further discusses safeguards for the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of personal data, while Mohamed et al. (2022) review authorization and access-control strategies that restrict system functions and information according to user permissions. In the proposed system, role-based access separates Admin maintenance and read-only oversight, Staff operations, Manager authorization, and Tenant-own functions. Rent email notifications will use authorized recipient records, protected sending credentials, and limited message content that directs tenants to the authenticated portal. These sources guide the study's quality and security evaluation, but they do not prove that the system already meets the selected quality characteristics or privacy requirements. The Security evaluation is limited to the defined system functions, access controls, and security-related criteria included in the study's evaluation procedures. It does not constitute a legal audit, certification, or claim of complete compliance with the Philippine Data Privacy Act.

1.3 Significance of the Study

The study develops and evaluates a web-based property-management workflow that uses OCR-based information extraction, rule-based billing classification, Web Push Notifications, and

supplementary rent email notifications. It primarily benefits property managers, operational Staff, and tenants and may serve as a reference for future researchers and system developers.

In the global context, the study contributes an applied example of PropTech and digital property management by showing how existing technologies can be combined into one workflow for residential property operations. It also provides a local example of how digital property-management concepts can be applied in a smaller property-management setting. The study does not claim that the proposed workflow represents all property-management environments; rather, its significance lies in demonstrating how selected technologies may be integrated within the defined scope of the study.

In the economic context, the system is designed to reduce repetitive manual activities involved in receiving utility bills, recording billing information, calculating tenant charges, and communicating billing updates. Centralized records and predefined billing rules can also help property managers follow a more consistent billing process. Processing time will be assessed during system evaluation. The study does not establish reductions in operating costs or late payments.

In the environmental context, the system uses electronic utility bills, digital billing records, and electronic notifications. This can reduce the need for paper-based records during the billing process. The study does not claim a specific reduction in paper use because this is not directly measured.

In the societal context, the system provides property managers and tenants with organized billing information. Itemized billing records, defined billing rules, and automated notifications can help make tenant dues easier to understand and communicate. This can support clearer billing transactions between property managers and tenants. However, the study does not claim that the system will eliminate billing misunderstandings or disputes because those outcomes are not directly measured.

## 1.4 Statement of the Problem

This study develops and evaluates an Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification for selected boarding houses and residential apartments in Pasig City.

Specifically, the study seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What development stages are undertaken in developing the proposed system using the Iterative Software Development Methodology?

2. How does the proposed system integrate OCR, rule-based billing processing, exception handling, payment management, digital receipts, Web Push Notifications, and supplementary rent email notifications into one property-management workflow?

3. How does the developed system perform when evaluated using the selected ISO/IEC 25010:2023 quality characteristics of Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Interaction Capability, Reliability, and Security?

4. What implementation guide and user manual can be prepared for the developed system?

## 1.5 Scope and Limitations of the Study

Our study will develop and evaluate a web-based property-management workflow for selected boarding houses and residential apartments in Pasig City during Academic Year 2026-2027. It will cover rent, electricity and water billing, with access assigned to Admin, Manager, Staff and Tenant accounts. Admin will handle account and system maintenance and permitted read-only inspection. Staff will perform authorized daily tasks and prepare corrections, while the Manager will control financial settings, correction decisions and rent confirmation. Tenants will access their own records and permitted functions.

Our system will receive supported utility-email summaries and attachments, together with optional uploads of clear printed-bill photographs or scans. It will use direct text extraction or OCR to obtain billing details, validate them, identify the billing arrangement and calculate individual or equal

shared charges. Processing will depend on readable supported documents and verified account mappings. Missing, masked, conflicting or otherwise invalid information will require review rather than guessed values or automatic finalization. Unsupported password-protected attachments will require review and an available supported copy. Routine valid bills will proceed automatically.

Rent functions will include fixed, non-prorated monthly anniversary billing, approved one-month advance handling for the final applicable rent cycle, payment reporting, Manager confirmation and confirmed rent receipts. Utility payment marks will remain personal Tenant tracking and will not establish provider settlement or produce utility receipts. Billing history, actual bill dates, labelled rent estimates, portal alerts, rent and utility Web Push, and supplementary rent-only email will support Tenant access. Rent estimates will not create charges or predict utility dates. Workspaces, basic reports, access controls, system-status checks and backups will support the included workflow rather than serve as separate research objectives. Detailed processing and permission rules are presented in Chapter II.

Our evaluation will use controlled conditions and selected properties. In the local setup, users will need a connection to the server's network; remote access will require a separately configured, reachable HTTPS address. The server must remain running for portal access and scheduled processing. Gmail retrieval and external notifications will require internet connectivity. The study will not establish readiness for large-scale deployment or guarantee continuous public availability, notification delivery or readership.

The study will exclude native mobile applications, smart-meter installation or reading, internet-service billing, payment gateways, automatic bank or provider-payment verification, provider-app access, SMS, predictive billing, model training, autonomous AI decisions, blockchain, maintenance tickets, automatic unit transfers or renewals, legal-contract generation and automated eviction. OCR will not cover handwritten, heavily damaged, severely distorted or low-resolution documents. Evaluation will address the five selected ISO/IEC 25010:2023 characteristics under the stated test conditions; it will not establish universal extraction accuracy, long-term business improvements or complete legal certification.

# CHAPTER II

# METHODOLOGY

This chapter presents the methodology and procedures that will guide the development of the proposed Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification. It describes the project requirements, system design, conceptual operation, interface mockups, and Iterative Software Development Methodology. It also presents the testing and evaluation procedures that will be used to examine the developed system within the approved scope of the study.

## 2.0 Project Overview

### Project Information

The project, entitled Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification, is a web-based system for selected boarding houses and residential apartments in Pasig City. It supports property, unit, tenant, rent, electricity, water, utility-mapping, billing, payment-status, exception, receipt, and applicable notification records. The system provides an integrated workflow for rent and utility billing. It receives supported utility-bill email summaries and attachments through the designated property-management email account and allows optional Staff or Manager uploads of clear photographs or scans of printed provider bills. Readable email and digitally generated PDF text is extracted directly, while clear bill images undergo OCR. Extracted information is validated and processed through predefined rules before billing computation and finalization. The system manages exceptions, records rent payment reports and Manager confirmations, supports approved use of confirmed advance credit, and provides digital receipts for confirmed rent payments. Electricity and water use separate personal tracking marks maintained by the assigned Tenant, without provider payment verification or system-issued utility receipts. Permitted Web Push billing updates and due-date reminders, together with supplementary rent email notifications, direct tenants to the authenticated portal.

In this study, intelligent refers to OCR-enabled document text extraction combined with predefined, explicit, deterministic, and traceable rules. The OCR component may use machine-learning-based text recognition to extract available document information, but it does not make autonomous billing, validation, allocation, payment, or property-management decisions. Readable email and digital-PDF text is also extracted directly before validation. Billing and property-management decisions use defined rules and Manager-controlled actions.

The local setup will run on a laptop or server using Node.js, SQLite and the HTML, CSS and JavaScript interface. Users on other devices will connect through the same local network and the configured portal address. A trusted HTTPS configuration will support secure browser access and Web Push; the local demonstration may require device certificate setup. Remote access will require a separately configured, reachable HTTPS address and is not established by the local tests. The backend must remain running for portal access and scheduled processing. Gmail retrieval, rent email and Web Push will require internet access, while supported local tasks will depend on the availability of the server and required local files.

## Requirements Definition

The proposed system is designed to meet the following business, user, and security requirements.

### A. Business Requirements

The system shall retrieve supported utility-bill email summaries and attachments from the designated property-management mailbox and allow optional Staff or Manager uploads of clear photographs or scans of printed provider bills. Direct text extraction or OCR shall obtain the amount due, due date, billing period, provider, and account or reference identifier according to the source format. Explicit, deterministic, and traceable rules shall check required values, provider/account mappings, periods, and duplicates across all supported intake methods, identify the billing category and individual or shared arrangement, and route unprocessable records to the Exception Queue. Masked or incomplete identifiers shall require Manager review against verified account information rather than inference of hidden characters. Only valid records shall proceed to

computation and finalization. Manager corrections shall undergo revalidation and, where applicable, reprocessing or recomputation, including corrections to finalized records.

Billing shall cover rent, electricity, and water. Fixed, non-prorated rent shall be generated once per lease cycle on the anniversary date, using the last calendar day when necessary and retaining the original day for later months. Missed eligible cycles shall be recovered once after server availability resumes, with original due dates and actual creation dates retained. One-month advance rent shall appear separately on the first bill and become available credit after payment confirmation. Only the Manager shall confirm applying available credit to the final applicable rent cycle. Applied amounts shall not be reused, and the system shall not automatically create a replacement advance charge. Shared charges shall be split equally among eligible tenants in the configured group, using the scheduled rent-cycle date for rent and the final day of the source period for utilities. For recovered rent cycles, eligibility shall use the original scheduled date rather than the recovery date. The eligible list shall be stored. Whole-centavo computation and remainder distribution in ascending permanent Tenant-record identifier order shall preserve the source total. Missing groups or eligible tenants shall require exception review. Duplicate billing, repeated advance-rent lines, and repeated credit application shall be prevented. Tenants shall arrange who pays a shared provider bill outside the system; calculating shares shall not establish provider settlement.

The centralized database shall retain property, unit, Tenant, mapping, rent, billing, rent-payment, utility-tracking, exception, correction, receipt, and applicable notification records. Rent bills shall use Unpaid, Tenant Reported Paid, and Paid. Tenant reports shall remain unconfirmed until Manager confirmation; the Manager may also record and confirm an actual rent payment without a prior report after external checking. Receipts shall be issued only for confirmed rent payments. Utilities shall use separate Not Marked Paid and Self-Reported Paid tracking labels, with the notice “Provider payment not verified.” Each utility mark shall belong to the reporting Tenant and the corresponding bill or allocated share, without authorizing a system-issued receipt or changing other tenants' marks. Tenants shall access their bills, stored portal notifications, history, rent

statuses, personal utility tracking, and confirmed rent receipts through the authenticated portal. Eligible reminders shall be scheduled at 9 AM Philippine time, three calendar days before the actual due date. Routine valid billing records shall proceed automatically, while records requiring review shall enter the Exception Queue for Staff investigation and Manager decisions where required. Web Push shall provide permitted rent and utility alerts. Supplementary email notifications shall cover rent billing updates, eligible rent reminders, and Manager-confirmed rent payment notices only. Outgoing rent email shall be separate from utility-email intake. The system shall use the Tenant's registered email address and retain queued events, channel-specific attempts, and available acceptance or failure results. Limited retries and duplicate controls shall prevent repeated sends during normal processing. Sending failure shall not change payment status or prevent portal access. SMS, GSM, and utility email notifications shall not be used.

B. User Requirements

The Admin shall manage authorized login accounts, roles, workspace membership and system maintenance. Admin shall also inspect permitted profile, contact, unit, bill, allocation, rent-status and system-generated rent receipt records across workspaces through a read-only view. The server shall limit returned fields and deny private uploaded files, original utility sources, raw extraction, full utility account references and authentication details. Admin shall not edit operational records, confirm rent, prepare or decide corrections, or change personal utility marks. Visible utility marks shall remain labelled Tenant-recorded and not verified. The Manager shall establish billing-linked property, unit and Tenant occupancy records, verified utility mappings and rent settings, and retain authority over sensitive billing corrections, rent confirmation and eligible final-cycle advance application. The Manager may also perform Staff operations. Staff shall access only their assigned workspace, update permitted descriptive details on existing records, upload utility bills, monitor email intake, inspect original sources and extraction results, and record investigation notes or escalations. Staff shall not directly change billing amounts, due dates, periods, mappings, allocation membership, rent settings, occupancy dates or login credentials of other users. Staff may prepare a single pending correction proposal containing the necessary

changes and a reason for an unfinalized incoming utility bill. Manager authorization shall check current authority, proposal freshness and applicable validation rules before atomic application; rejection, stale data or failed validation shall leave proposed billing changes unapplied and retain the handling reason. Manager direct corrections shall use existing safeguards and preserve history without requiring another Manager signature. Finalized billing corrections shall remain Manager-controlled, and no authorization shall override duplicate protection. Valid bills shall proceed automatically without routine human approval.

Tenants shall view their own assigned unit, bills, history, permitted portal notifications, confirmed rent receipts and personal utility tracker. Tenants may report rent payment for Manager confirmation, while the Manager may directly record and confirm an externally checked rent payment without a prior report. Rent statuses shall remain Unpaid, Tenant Reported Paid and Paid. Utilities shall retain Not Marked Paid and Self-Reported Paid with the notice "Provider payment not verified." Only the assigned Tenant shall change a personal utility mark; Staff and Manager shall not verify provider settlement or issue utility receipts. Permitted Web Push and supplementary rent email notifications shall direct Tenants to the authenticated portal. Staff may view workspace rent statuses and existing confirmed receipts for operational support without creating or altering them; financial summary reports shall remain Manager-only.

C. Security Requirements

The system shall require valid credentials, restrict functions and records according to the Admin, Staff, Manager and Tenant roles, and limit property, tenant, utility, billing, payment, exception, correction, receipt, notification and source-document access to authorized users and functions. Authentication, defined permissions and session management shall protect records from unauthorized access or modification. User-provided information shall be checked before storage, and invalid form or API submissions shall be rejected without saving the proposed changes. Incoming utility sources that fail required-field, identification, mapping, period, duplicate or other processing checks shall be held for review in the Exception Queue. Correction information shall be retained in the centralized database. Outgoing email shall use authorized Tenant recipient records

and TLS-protected submission to the configured mail service. Sending credentials shall remain in protected backend configuration and shall not be exposed to browser code, notification content, or exports. Messages shall contain limited alert information and direct tenants to authenticated records; an email link shall not bypass access restrictions. These requirements cover the implemented controls and evaluation criteria and do not constitute legal certification or a complete privacy audit.

## 2.1 Concept of the Study

### Architectural Framework

The framework connects property and unit records, tenant records, utility-account mappings, and rent settings with utility intake, text extraction or OCR, validation, classification, and billing computation. It also includes exception handling, rent confirmation, advance-credit application, confirmed rent receipts, personal utility tracking, and permitted notifications. These functions use one centralized database. Admin maintains accounts and authorized workspace assignments and inspects permitted records across workspaces through a read-only view. Staff handles permitted daily operations and investigates exceptions, while the Manager controls financial settings and decisions. Tenants access their own records, and utility providers supply billing information through supported sources.

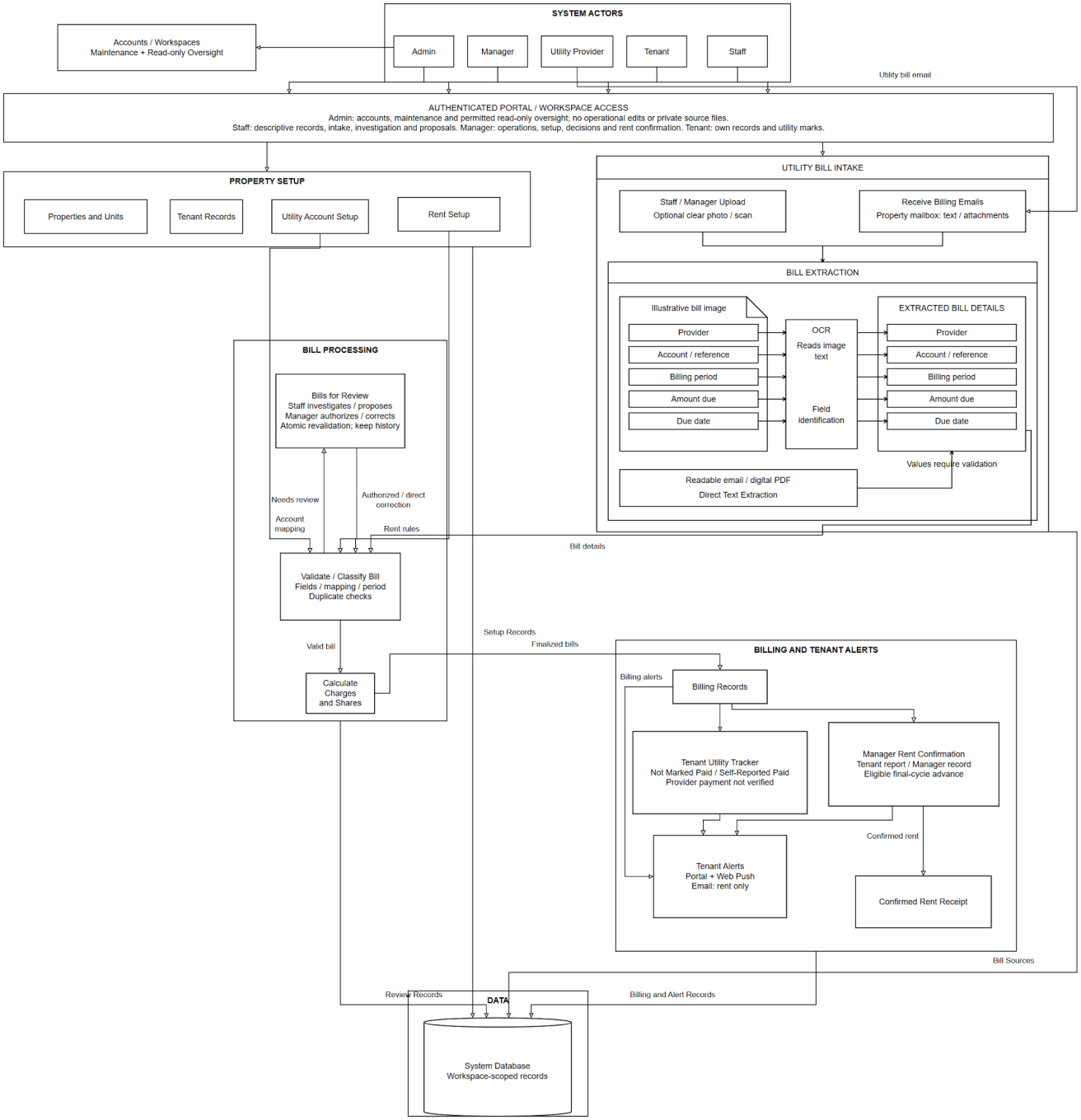



Figure 2.1: Architectural Framework

Property and Unit Management manages property and unit information. Tenant Management manages Tenant information and its association with the applicable property or unit. Utility Provider and Account/Reference Mapping stores the provider, account or billing number, covered property or unit, and Manager-selected Individual or Shared-Occupancy Billing Arrangement. Individual utility bills follow the assigned account without splitting. Shared bills are divided equally among eligible tenants in the configured group. Tenants decide which person pays the whole

shared provider bill outside the system; the allocation does not represent collection or verified payment.

Rent will be generated once per monthly lease cycle on the configured anniversary date, which will also be its due date. The charge will be fixed and non-prorated, with its coverage period recorded. If the anniversary day is absent, the system will use the month's last day and retain the original day for later months; a January 31 anniversary therefore uses February 28 or 29 and then March 31. If the server is unavailable, missed eligible cycles will be recovered once when processing resumes. Each recovered bill will retain its original due date, coverage period, and scheduled eligibility date while recording its actual creation date. Generation checks will prevent duplicate cycles, repeated advance-rent lines, and new cycles after the lease end date. Existing unpaid charges will remain accessible, and later membership changes will not silently replace finalized bills. Rental records will use a start date and an optional end date for month-to-month occupancy. A blank end date will mean that the rental continues; it will not require a separate renewal transaction. When the Manager records the Tenant's departure date, rent generation will stop for cycles scheduled after that date. Previous charges and their associated tracking, payments, and receipts will be retained. The study will not include automatic transfers between units or automatic lease-renewal processing.

The first bill will show current rent and one-month advance rent as separate rent lines. Advance rent is not a security deposit and will become available credit only after Manager confirmation of its payment. Shared tenants will have separate current-rent and advance-rent shares. Available advance credit will be reserved for the final applicable rent cycle and applied only after Manager confirmation. The system will display the final-cycle charge, confirmed available credit, and remaining balance before application. If the approved credit fully covers the charge, the bill will become Paid using the original confirmed payment and receipt reference, without another cash payment or duplicate receipt. Applied credit shall not exceed the available confirmed amount and shall not be reused. Fully consumed credit will no longer be available for another charge, and no replacement advance charge will be generated automatically. Only a remaining outstanding

balance may be reported for payment. Credit shall not be applied to a bill already marked Paid; a pending rent report shall require Manager review before application. A mismatch between available credit and the final-cycle charge will require Manager review rather than an invented refund or automatic settlement.

The designated property-management mailbox will retrieve supported utility-bill email summaries and attachments. Staff or the Manager may also upload a clear photograph or scan of a printed provider bill. All supported sources will follow the same validation, mapping, and duplicate-checking workflow. Readable email summaries and digitally generated PDF text will be extracted directly, while an existing OCR engine will recognize text from clear images of selected provider layouts without researcher training or customization of a machine-learning model. Predefined extraction rules will obtain the amount due, due date, billing period, provider, and account or reference identifier while retaining the source reference. Text extraction and OCR will not establish payment status, billing validity, or Tenant charges; extracted fields will undergo validation and mapping. Actual validated utility due dates will be used for billing and reminders, without predicting dates for documents not yet received. The system will not automatically access provider apps or read phone notifications. A separately configured outgoing email function will send supplementary rent alerts; it will not depend on retrieving a utility-provider email.

Absent, unreadable or conflicting values, and unsupported attachments, will require exception review rather than finalized charges. Supported email formats, document layouts, file types and processing limits will be documented before final testing. Evaluation will compare extracted fields with manually checked samples and report results only within the declared email and document boundaries. If a provider sends only a notification link or insufficient billing information, the record will require Manager review and an available supported source; a complete PDF attachment or unmasked account identifier will not be assumed.

Validation will check required fields, currency amounts, valid dates and a billing period whose beginning does not follow its end. Account identifiers will remain text to preserve leading zeros. A unique Manager-configured provider/account mapping will identify electricity or water and the

covered property or unit; its saved configuration will determine the billing arrangement. Provider aliases will follow an explicit list. Missing, conflicting, invalid or unmappable values will enter the Exception Queue rather than being guessed. Masked or incomplete identifiers will remain unresolved until Manager review establishes the correct registered account. The system will not guess hidden characters. Rent will follow saved configuration without OCR classification.

Duplicate checks will compare source copies and provider/account/period combinations across email summaries, attachments, and uploads with existing records. Repeated or revised bills will require Manager review before another charge or correction is accepted, and reprocessing an accepted source will not create duplicate allocations. Each result will retain its source reference, normalized fields and applied rule identifiers. Corrected records must pass the same checks before computation and finalization.

Table 2.1: Validation and classification rules

| Rule ID | Rule Name | Description | Action/Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| V01 | Required information | Amount, due date, billing period, provider, or account identifier is missing, masked, incomplete, or conflicting | Exception Queue; no finalization |
| V02 | Valid values | Amount or date cannot be interpreted, amount is negative, or | Exception Queue; Manager review |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | period begins after it ends | |
| V03 | Unique mapping | Provider/account identifies exactly one configured target and category | Continue; otherwise Exception Queue |
| V04 | Duplicate check | Identical source copy or the same provider/account/period is already recorded across supported intake methods | Hold for duplicate or revised-bill review |
| C01 | Utility category | Configured provider/account mapping identifies electricity or water | Assign mapped category |
| C02 | Billing arrangement | Target has a valid individual/shared configuration | Apply saved arrangement; otherwise Exception Queue |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| A01 | Allocation | Eligible group and reconciled shares are available | Proceed to finalization; otherwise Exception Queue |
| R01 | Rent cycle | Lease/cycle already has a rent charge | Do not generate a second charge |

Individual charges will follow the configured lease or utility account. Shared rent and utility charges will be split equally among eligible tenants in the Manager-configured property or unit group, without consumption estimates or meter readings. Eligibility will use active assignments on the scheduled rent-cycle date for rent and on the source period's final day for utilities, excluding assignments already ended. Recovered rent cycles will use their original scheduled eligibility dates. The system will retain the eligible list so later occupancy changes do not alter finalized charges. Missing groups, periods, or eligible tenants will enter the Exception Queue. Computation will divide the source charge in whole centavos, assigning equal base shares and distributing leftover centavos in ascending permanent Tenant-record identifier order. PHP 100.00 split among three tenants will produce PHP 33.34, PHP 33.33, and PHP 33.33. Shares will display two decimal places and must total the source charge before finalization. For shared utilities, tenants will arrange one person to pay the whole provider bill outside the system. Personal tracking will refer only to each Tenant's allocated share and will not establish payment of the full provider account.

The Exception Queue will block finalization until the applicable Manager decision and successful validation. Staff may investigate, add notes and propose corrections to unfinalized sources without changing live billing. Manager authorization will check current access and billing context, apply all proposed fields together and rerun validation. Rejected, stale or invalid proposals will retain reasons and leave the proposed billing change unapplied. Managers may also correct directly.

Corrections will retain previous and new values, reason, preparer and authorizer where applicable. Unresolved records will remain blocked; submitting a correction alone will not establish validity.

Billing Records will retain rent and utility charges while separating rent confirmation from personal utility tracking. Rent will use Unpaid, Tenant Reported Paid, and Paid. Tenants may report full payment of a selected outstanding rent balance; partial payments and overpayments will not be processed automatically. Only one pending rent report shall be retained per bill, and repeated submissions shall not create another report. Tenant reports will remain pending until the Manager checks the payment outside the system. Rejection will record a reason, restore Unpaid, and preserve report history. The Manager may also record and confirm an actual rent payment without a prior Tenant report after external checking. Either confirmation path will retain the confirmed amount, payment date, Manager identity, and unique receipt. Repeated submission or confirmation of the same transaction will not create another payment or receipt.

Electricity and water will use the personal tracking labels Not Marked Paid and Self-Reported Paid, accompanied by “Provider payment not verified.” Tenants may change only their own bill or allocated-share mark, with dated history retained. In shared arrangements, tenants will decide which person pays the provider bill; a personal mark will not change other tenants' marks or establish settlement of the entire account. Utility tracking will require neither Manager confirmation nor a system-issued receipt. A mark will refer to the recorded bill or allocation version, so later charge corrections will preserve earlier history and require Tenant review of the revised information. The system will not independently verify cash, bank transfers, electronic-wallet transactions, Tenant contributions, or utility-provider payments.

Finalized corrections will preserve prior values and processing history. Unpaid rent charges may be corrected after revalidation and recomputation; pending reports must be reviewed against revised amounts. Paid rent bills will retain their original payment and receipt, with corrections recorded as linked revisions showing charge and balance changes. Utility corrections will retain their original source, allocation, and associated personal tracking history and undergo applicable

validation and recomputation. External payments or refunds will remain outside automated settlement. Tenants will access current and historical records through the authenticated portal.

The Centralized Database will relate properties, units, tenants, leases, utility mappings, billing sources, allocations, rent payment reports, Manager-recorded payments and confirmations, confirmed rent receipts, advance-credit applications, utility tracking history, exceptions, corrections, and notifications. Recorded assignments will support multiple tenants per shared unit. Allocations will link to their source and eligible group; rent payments and receipts will link to their bills. Personal utility tracking will link to the assigned Tenant and the relevant bill or allocated share. Notification records will link billing events to recipients and applicable channels, retaining schedules, attempts, and available sending results. These relationships will preserve transaction history and support access restrictions. Corrections will remain centralized records rather than a separate architectural component. The database design will define storage relationships while the framework, flowchart, and DFD describe structure and operation.

Web Push will provide external alerts for rent and utility records, while supplementary email will be limited to rent billing updates, eligible rent reminders, and Manager-confirmed rent payment notices. On a supported browser, Tenant permission will allow creation and storage of an account/device subscription and the background handling needed to receive a Web Push alert. Rent email will use the Tenant's registered email address and a configured SMTP service through a TLS-protected connection. Alerts will direct tenants to authenticated records without revealing complete billing details beforehand or changing payment status. Finalization and relevant corrections will trigger billing updates. A confirmed rent payment notice will refer to the existing confirmed transaction and receipt rather than create another payment or receipt.

Reminders will be scheduled at 9 AM Philippine time, three calendar days before the actual due date, for eligible Unpaid rent and utility records Not Marked Paid. Rent reminders will use the applicable Web Push and email channels; utility reminders will use Web Push only. Rent reports awaiting Manager confirmation and utility records marked Self-Reported Paid will be excluded. A utility reminder will prompt the Tenant to check whether the bill or share has been paid;

suppressing it after a personal mark will not establish provider settlement. Corrected due dates will replace pending schedules, and repeated events will not duplicate reminders. Bills unavailable before the scheduled reminder time, including same-day rent and late recovered bills, will receive billing updates rather than backdated reminders. If the server misses the reminder time, it will not send a retrospective reminder for that missed event.

Portal notifications will retain alerts for tenants to view after login, regardless of external delivery. Notification records will distinguish scheduling, attempts, and available push-service or email-server acceptance and failure results for each channel. One billing event will link to its applicable channel records, with limited retries and duplicate prevention. An accepted message will not prove device delivery, inbox delivery, or readership. Email sending will require internet connectivity, protected sending credentials, and a running backend. Invalid subscriptions, denied permission, unsupported devices, unavailable email configuration, and sending failures will not prevent authenticated access to bills, rent statuses, personal utility tracking, or confirmed rent receipts. Tenant SMS, GSM, and utility email notifications will remain excluded.

The Admin performs account and system maintenance and read-only inspection of permitted workspace records. Inspection does not grant operational editing, rent confirmation, correction authority or private-file access. The Manager controls billing setup, verified mappings, sensitive corrections, rent confirmation and eligible advance application while retaining operational access. Staff performs permitted descriptive updates, bill intake monitoring, source inspection, investigation and correction preparation in the assigned workspace. The shared Exception Queue retains responsibility, notes and proposal decisions on related records; it does not duplicate bills between Staff and Manager queues. Valid bills continue automatically. The Tenant views own records, reports rent and maintains personal utility tracking. The Utility Provider supplies supported electronic summaries or documents through the designated property-management mailbox, or printed bills submitted as clear images by Staff or Manager. Provider settlement and shared-bill contribution collection remain outside independent system verification.

The components form one web-based workflow. Saved property, Tenant, mapping, and rent information supports utility intake, direct text extraction, OCR, validation, allocation, and exception handling. Rent payment confirmation, final-cycle advance credit, confirmed rent receipts, and personal utility tracking remain separate functions. The Centralized Database retains their records, while Web Push provides permitted rent and utility alerts and email provides supplementary rent alerts. Each actor uses only the functions assigned to their role.

2.2 Conceptual Operation

The workflow uses property, Tenant, utility-mapping, and rent configuration to process rent, electricity, and water charges. Monthly rent follows the fixed anniversary rule, with one-month advance rent shown separately on the first bill. Missed eligible cycles are recovered once with original due dates and actual creation dates retained. Utility processing receives supported property-email summaries and attachments or Staff- or Manager-uploaded clear images of printed bills. Readable email and digital-PDF text is extracted directly; clear images undergo OCR. Required information, mappings, periods, and duplicates are validated, while masked or incomplete identifiers require Manager review against verified account information. Valid records proceed to classification, computation, and finalization; Staff may investigate exceptions and submit proposals; Manager authorization or direct correction and renewed validation are required before blocked bills proceed.

Shared charges use equal splitting among configured eligible tenants, using the scheduled rent-cycle date or the utility period's final day. Whole-centavo computation and consistent remainder distribution preserve the source total. Rent begins as Unpaid; Tenant reports become Tenant Reported Paid until Manager confirmation, while rejected reports return to Unpaid with recorded reasons. The Manager may also record and confirm externally checked rent payments without a Tenant report. Confirmed advance credit may cover the final applicable rent bill with Manager-confirmed application, reusing the original payment and receipt rather than recording another cash transaction. Consumed credit cannot be reused, and no replacement advance is charged automatically. Utilities use separate Tenant-controlled Not Marked Paid and Self-Reported

Paid marks with “Provider payment not verified.” Tenants arrange the payer of a shared provider bill outside the system; individual marks do not confirm payment of the full account or authorize receipts. Web Push provides rent and utility billing updates and eligible reminders, while supplementary email provides rent billing updates, eligible reminders, and Manager-confirmed rent payment notices. Reminders at 9 AM Philippine time, three calendar days before the actual due date, follow the defined unpaid-status, pending-report, personal-mark, and bill-availability rules. Rent generated on its due date receives a billing update rather than a backdated reminder. Both channels link to the authenticated portal without proving payment, delivery, or reading.

Process Flowchart

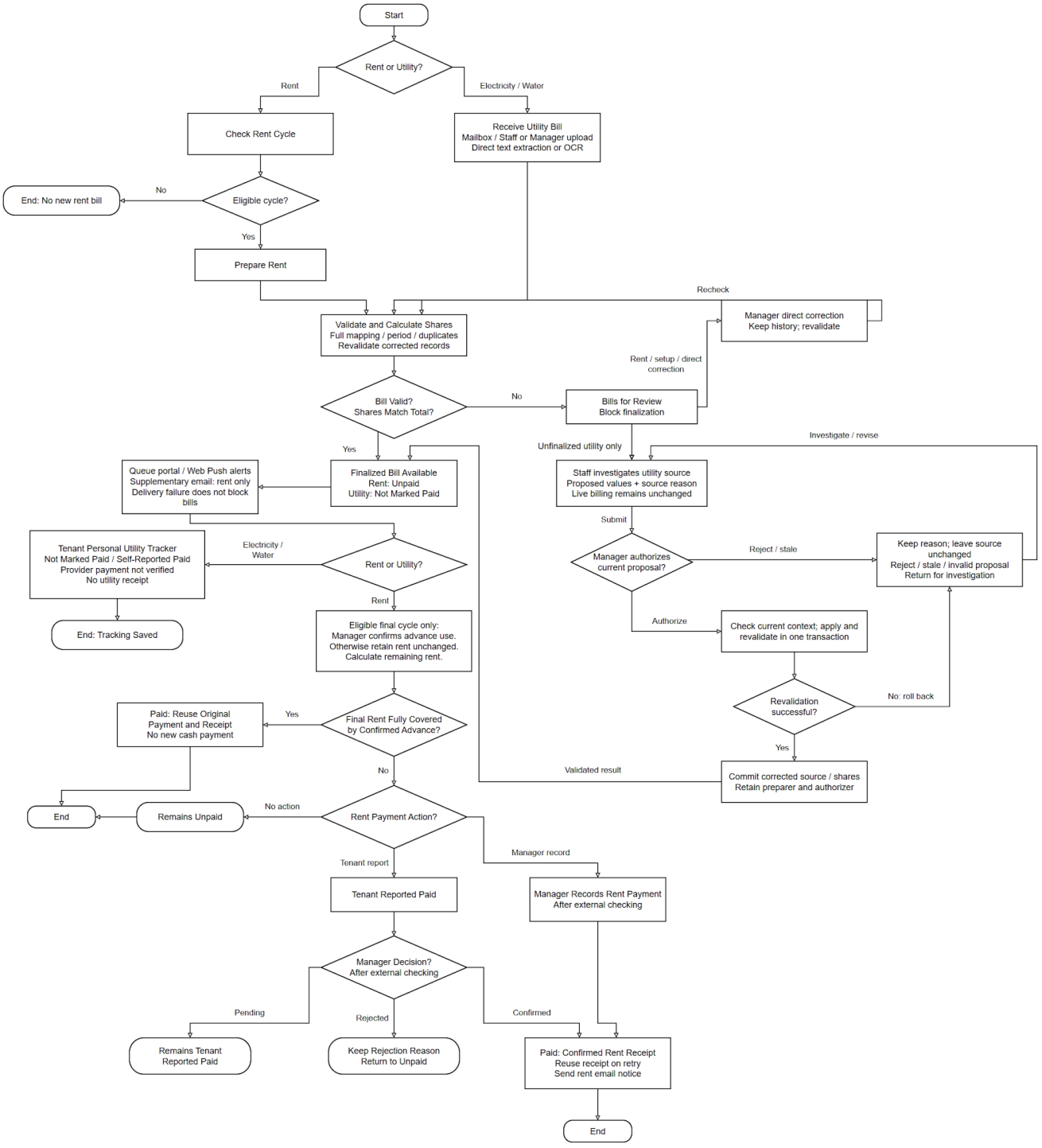



Figure 2.2. Overall Process Flowchart

The flowchart shows rent and utility intake, validation, allocation and finalization. Staff investigates failed incoming utility records and may prepare a correction proposal. Manager authorization checks freshness and reruns validation atomically; rejected, stale or invalid proposals return for review without applying their proposed billing change. Manager direct correction remains available

with retained history. Rent continues through Tenant reporting or direct Manager recording, confirmation, and confirmed rent receipts; final-cycle advance credit reuses the original transaction references. Utilities continue through separate personal tracking without Manager payment confirmation or system-issued receipts. Web Push supports both billing paths through permitted alerts, while supplementary email applies to rent only. Sending outcomes do not change billing or payment status.

Full-Blown Data Flow Diagram

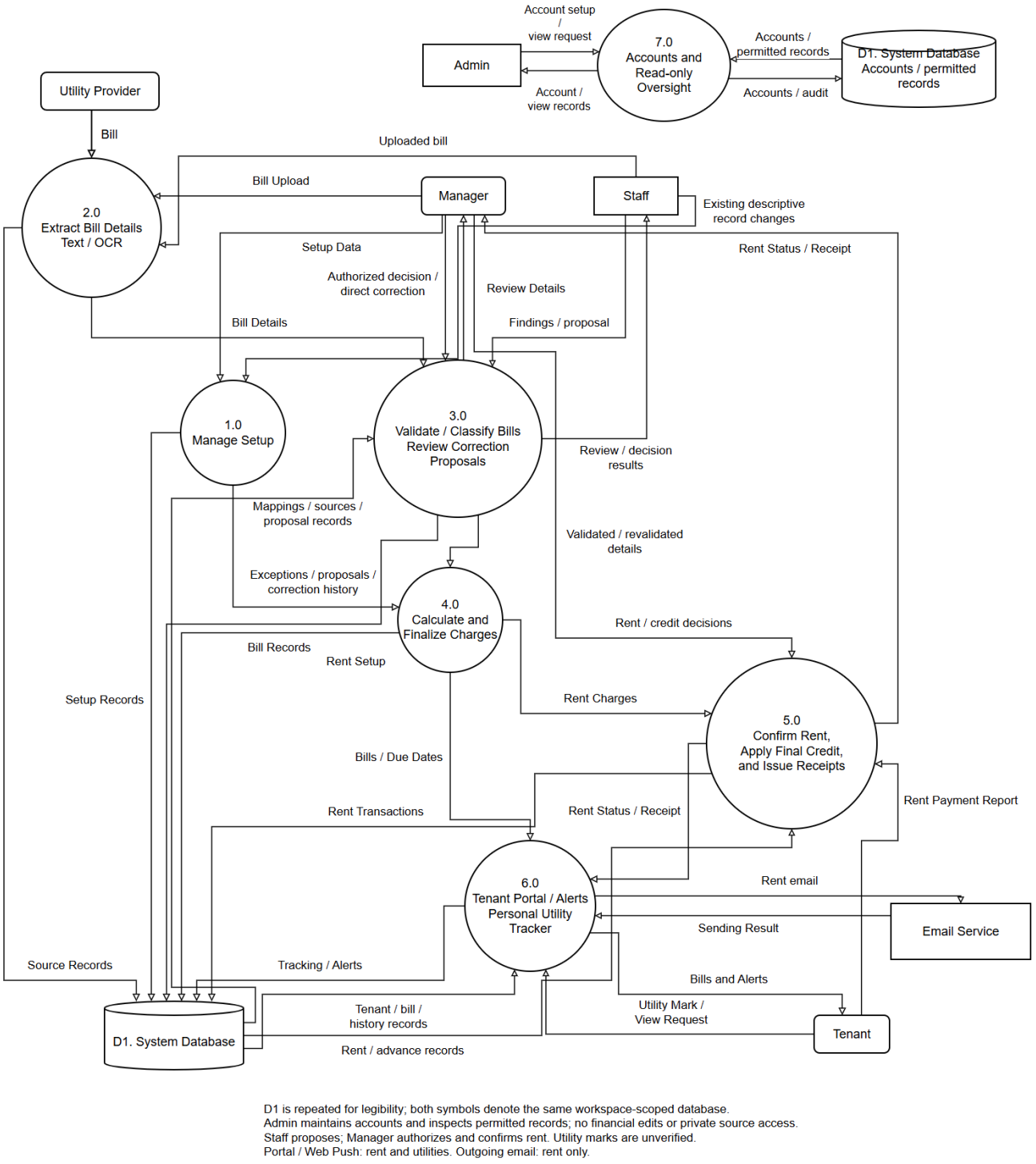



Figure 2.3. Data Flow Diagram

The DFD illustrates how billing-related information moves among Admin, Staff, Manager, Tenant, Utility Provider, system processes and Centralized Database. Supporting process 7.0 handles Admin account and workspace maintenance and provides permitted read-only workspace records. Its account and audit writes remain separate from operational billing changes; private source files

and raw extraction are not returned through inspection. The repeated D1 symbols represent the same logical database and do not introduce separate databases. Staff supplies permitted descriptive updates, uploads, investigation notes and correction proposals. The Manager supplies authorized correction decisions and financial/setup instructions; related decision details and exception records return to the authorized users. It shows the flow of configuration data, utility-bill information, billing records, payment information, receipt information, and tenant notification information through the system processes. The outgoing email service will receive permitted rent alert information from the notification process, and available sending results will return to the system for recording. Utility-email intake and outgoing rent alerts will remain separate data flows. External entities interact with the system through the appropriate processes, while the Centralized Database stores and provides the records required by the system.

## 2.3 Mockup Design

The mockups present the Admin, Staff, Manager and Tenant interfaces through one sign-in form with access determined after authentication. Shared operational pages expose role-permitted actions rather than separate application copies. Staff views emphasize intake and investigation; Manager views emphasize decisions while preserving operational access; Admin views cover account search, business membership, maintenance and read-only workspace inspection with a persistent workspace label. Tenant views retain rent first, the personal utility tracker below rent, bill history, confirmed rent receipts and permitted notifications. Correction views show original and proposed values, evidence, preparer, decision and handling reasons. These designs guide development and do not establish improved usability or completed evaluation results. The current interface uses cream, mint and dark-green colors, local illustrations, clear navigation labels and layouts that adjust to desktop and phone screens. Decorative elements do not replace the actual bill details or role permissions.

## 2.4 Methodology of the Study

The study will use the Iterative Software Development Methodology to develop the proposed Intelligent Property Management Workflow with OCR-Enabled Automated Billing Classification and Tenant Notification. This methodology will organize development into successive iterations in which related system functions will be planned, designed, developed, reviewed, refined, and integrated.

The methodology is appropriate because the system can be developed in related groups of functions and checked as each group is added. These groups cover configuration, utility intake and extraction, validation, billing, payment records, tenant access, and notifications. Valid records will proceed automatically, while exceptions will require the appropriate user action.

### 2.4.1 Principles of the Iterative Methodology

The Iterative Software Development Methodology will be guided by four development principles and the system's exception-based workflow. First, incremental development will allow the researchers to develop related system functions in smaller iterations instead of implementing the entire system at once. Second, continuous testing and review will allow each iteration to be checked against the defined requirements, user roles, workflow rules, and data requirements.

Third, refinement between iterations will allow issues identified during development to be corrected before related functions are integrated into succeeding iterations. Fourth, cumulative integration will allow functions developed in earlier iterations to work with functions developed later until they form a complete system.

Throughout the iterations, development and testing will preserve the system's exception-based workflow. Valid records will proceed automatically, while records requiring review will enter the shared Exception Queue for Staff investigation and Manager decisions where required.

2.4.2 Development Iterations of the Methodology

The proposed system will be developed through seven planned iterations based on the functional requirements of the study. Each iteration will focus on a related group of functions that will later be integrated into the complete system.

Table 2.2: Development Iterations of the Proposed System

| Iteration | Development Focus | Main Functions |
|---|---|---|
| Iteration 1 | Requirements and System Foundation | User roles, authentication, property, unit, tenant, and Centralized Database structure |
| Iteration 2 | Property and Billing Configuration | Utility providers, account or reference mapping, rent configuration, billing arrangements, and billing rules |
| Iteration 3 | Property-Management Email Intake, Bill Upload, Text Extraction, and OCR | Designated email intake, supported email-summary parsing, attachment retrieval, optional Staff or Manager upload of clear printed-bill images, supported digital-PDF |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | text extraction, and image OCR |
| Iteration 4 | Rule-Based Validation and Exception Handling | Required-field checking, mapping, billing-period checking, duplicate checking, billing classification, shared Exception Queue, Staff investigation and correction proposals, Manager correction decisions, and revalidation |
| Iteration 5 | Billing Computation and Finalization | Rent, electricity, and water billing; Individual and Shared-Occupancy Billing Arrangements; allocation; computation; and Billing Finalization |
| Iteration 6 | Rent Payment, Utility Tracking, Digital Receipt, and Tenant Notifications | Rent statuses, Tenant rent reporting, Manager-recorded payments and confirmation, final-cycle advance-credit application, confirmed rent receipts, personal utility tracking, Tenant portal access and stored notifications, Web |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | Push alerts, and supplementary rent email notifications |
| Iteration 7 | System Integration and Testing | Integration of system functions, implemented security controls, system-wide testing, and final evaluation |

2.4.3 Application of the Methodology to the Study

The iterations will begin with system foundation and configuration, followed by utility intake, extraction, validation, and billing. Later iterations will add payment records, tenant access, receipts, and permitted notifications. Each iteration will build on the functions completed earlier.

During development, each iteration will undergo planning, design, development, testing and review, followed by refinement and integration. Findings from testing and review will be used to correct related functions before succeeding components are integrated. Records requiring Manager intervention will be handled through the Exception Queue according to the defined processing rules.

The final iteration will integrate the developed functions and conduct system-wide testing and evaluation. The completed system will be evaluated using the selected ISO/IEC 25010:2023 quality characteristics: Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Interaction Capability, Reliability, and Security. This chapter describes the planned methodology. Recorded development activities and testing results are presented separately in Chapter III; formal evaluation is reported only when completed.

This approach will organize related functions into manageable development cycles. Repeated testing and review will help identify defects and maintain consistency among requirements, roles, workflows, and data structures. Gradual integration will connect these functions while preserving the intended automate-by-default, intervene-by-exception approach.

### 2.4.4 System Testing and Evaluation Procedures

Testing will occur during each iteration and after integration, using business, user and security requirements. Cases will cover normal transactions, incomplete fields, unmapped or masked accounts, duplicates and corrected exceptions, recording inputs, expected and observed results, and pass or failure. Defects will be corrected and affected tests repeated before final evaluation. Email parsing, digital-PDF extraction, and image OCR results for the five target fields will be compared with manually checked sources. Results will be reported separately by extraction method so successful text parsing is not treated as evidence of image OCR accuracy. Field accuracy will equal correctly extracted values divided by expected values, multiplied by one hundred; missing and incorrect values will be recorded. Declared normalization rules must preserve meaning. Email and document sets and rules will be fixed before final testing, with refinement samples identified separately from final evaluation samples.

Validation, mapping, classification, and exception routing will be checked against predefined outcomes for supported email-body summaries, email attachments, and Staff- or Manager-uploaded printed-bill images. Tests will check that missing or masked identifiers remain unresolved until Manager review and that repeated sources across intake methods do not create another charge. Rent and utility computations will be checked independently, including individual shares, exact source reconciliation, anniversary dates, short-month handling, and missed-cycle recovery without duplicate charges. Rent payment tests will verify Tenant reporting, direct Manager recording after external checking, Manager-only confirmation, approved advance-credit use, remaining-balance reporting, and original-receipt reuse without repeated credit or automatic replacement charges. Utility tracking tests will verify that only the assigned Tenant may change their own mark, dated history is retained, and no mark establishes provider settlement or

generates a system-issued utility receipt. Reminder tests will check the 9 AM Philippine-time cutoff, three-calendar-day timing, late bills, pending rent reports, and self-reported utility marks. Repeated processing will be checked for duplicate charges, payments, credit applications, receipts, or reminders. Notification tests will check the correct rent recipient and event, rent-only email scope, authenticated portal links, separate channel records, sending failures, limited retries, and duplicate prevention. Controlled real email sending will be distinguished from simulated transport tests; neither email-server nor push-service acceptance will be treated as proof of readership.

Functional Suitability will use requirement tests; Performance Efficiency will use processing and response measurements under a stated environment; Interaction Capability will use representative tasks and an adviser-reviewed questionnaire; Reliability will use repeated-processing, notification retry, and recovery tests; and Security will use authentication, role, unauthorized-record-access, email-recipient, and sending-credential protection tests. User ratings will supplement rather than replace technical evidence.

Staff will upload bills, investigate exceptions and submit correction proposals. Managers will review escalations, authorize or reject proposals, make permitted direct corrections, record or confirm rent payments, and apply eligible final-cycle credit. Tenants will view bills and history, report outstanding rent, use personal utility tracking, access confirmed rent receipts, and follow permitted notification links to the authenticated portal. Controlled rent email receipt and link access will be checked separately from backend sending results. Task completion and difficulties will be recorded. Questionnaire responses will use the approved scale and scoring procedure, while technical results will use counts, percentages, time summaries, and failed-case descriptions. Evaluator selection and counts, document counts, and questionnaire scoring will be settled with the adviser before final data collection. This section specifies the evaluation procedure rather than its results. Chapter III distinguishes the completed development checks from the formal evaluation activities that remain pending.

Role tests will verify Staff read/write boundaries across direct API calls and interface actions, one pending proposal per source, stale-context and preparer-access changes, rejected or invalid corrections, repeated decision attempts and retained history. A Manager decision shall not bypass the original validation and financial-history safeguards. Account, bill and source access shall be tested across workspaces, with authorized Admin maintenance and read-only inspection distinguished from operational billing authority. Direct requests shall verify that Admin cannot change operational records, confirm rent, decide proposals or open private source files; inspection shall return only permitted fields and fail without returning record data if its required audit write fails. Synthetic fixtures, actual-provider samples, automated checks and real-device results shall be reported separately.

# CHAPTER III

# RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

This chapter presents the system's capabilities, development stages, and recorded testing results. Sections 3.1.1 to 3.1.4 answer the four research questions in Chapter I in the same order. Section 3.2 reports the test environment, procedures, results, identified issues, and recommendations. The discussion uses verified development evidence and distinguishes it from formal participant evaluation, which has not yet been conducted.

## 3.1 Project Capabilities and Testing Process Details

### 3.1.1 Development Stages Undertaken Using the Iterative Software Development Methodology

To answer the first research question, the system was developed through repeated planning, design, development, testing, and review. Related functions were added gradually and checked with the existing functions. The seven development areas below follow the iteration plan in Chapter II.

Development began with the billing scope, user responsibilities, record relationships, authentication, and workspace access. The system includes Admin, Staff, Manager, and Tenant roles. Staff handles permitted daily operations and investigation, while the Manager retains financial authority. Admin maintains accounts and inspects permitted workspace records through a read-only view, without confirming rent, changing operational records or opening private source files. Shared pages use the same records, while server permissions determine the information and actions available to each role. This does not create a second login identity or allow Admin impersonation.

Property and billing configuration connected properties, units, tenant occupancy, rent settings, and verified utility-account mappings. Saved settings determine individual and shared billing arrangements. Configured rent, generated charges, confirmed rent payments, and personal utility marks remain separate records.

Utility intake was added through the designated property mailbox and optional Staff or Manager uploads. Readable email summaries and digital PDFs use direct text extraction, while supported images and scanned PDFs use OCR. The system retains each source and extracts the amount due, due date, billing period, provider, and account or reference identifier. Unsupported, encrypted, unreadable, masked, or conflicting sources require review and a readable supported source when necessary. The system does not recover document passwords or guess hidden account details.

Validation checks required fields, dates, billing periods, account mappings, and duplicates. Staff may investigate an unfinalized source and submit a correction proposal with a reason. A proposal does not change live billing. Before applying an authorized correction, the system checks that the source and billing context are still current and repeats validation in one transaction. Rejected, outdated, or invalid proposals leave the proposed change unapplied. Valid sources proceed automatically without approval of every bill.

Billing computation follows the configured monthly rent anniversary and short-month rule. Shared charges are divided in whole centavos so that the shares equal the source total. Repeated processing is checked to prevent duplicate charges. Only the Manager may authorize final-cycle advance application, which reuses the original confirmed payment and receipt.

Rent reporting, confirmation, receipts, utility tracking, and notifications were then connected to tenant access. A Tenant may report rent payment for Manager confirmation after external checking. The Manager may also record an externally checked payment directly. Only confirmed rent produces a rent receipt. Electricity and water use personal tracking marks that do not verify provider payment. Portal alerts, supplementary rent email, and Web Push use separate channels. The calendar shows actual utility due dates and labelled future rent estimates.

The integrated system was checked through service, HTTP, browser, extraction, persistence, and access-isolation tests. Identified issues were investigated and corrected, then the affected tests were repeated. Section 3.2 presents the recorded results.

### 3.1.2 Integration of the Main System Functions

To answer the second research question, the implemented workflow connects utility-email retrieval or upload to source storage, direct extraction or OCR, validation, classification, allocation, finalization, and Tenant access. An unresolved source enters the review process without silently generating valid charges. Staff investigation and Manager decisions retain reasons and history. Repeated intake and repeated decisions must not create duplicate financial records.

Rent management follows its own reporting and confirmation path. A pending Tenant report is not a confirmed payment. Confirmed rent receipts retain the recorded transaction details. Personal utility tracking remains separate and does not produce utility receipts. Notification processing supports access to these records but does not change payment status or establish delivery to a human reader.

The local setup requires a running backend, and users on other devices need a connection to the server's network and the configured portal address. Local access does not by itself establish access from other networks. Remote access requires a separately configured, reachable HTTPS address. Live mailbox retrieval and external notifications require internet access. Supported local processing can continue when the server, required files and components are available.

### 3.1.3 Testing Process and Evaluation Basis

Development testing used disposable and synthetic records to check expected behavior and failure handling. Functional checks exercised intake, corrections, computation, reports, receipts, and personal utility tracking. Reliability checks exercised replay, duplicate prevention, restart persistence, and independent job failures. Access-control checks exercised role and workspace restrictions through both interface actions and direct requests. Browser checks exercised desktop and phone-sized layouts.

The third research question concerns the five selected ISO/IEC 25010:2023 characteristics in Chapters I and II: Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Interaction Capability, Reliability, and Security. Requirement tests, measured processing observations, browser tasks, recovery

checks, and access-control checks provide development-level evidence. No participant ratings or overall ISO quality score are reported because the adviser-reviewed user evaluation has not yet been conducted.

Functional Suitability is supported by checks of intake, validation, allocation, correction handling, rent confirmation, receipt access, and personal utility tracking. The existing document catalog was also checked against its recorded field expectations. These results describe the exercised cases and support consistency checking; they do not establish extraction accuracy for a representative collection of provider bills.

Performance Efficiency was examined through local API response measurements and observed extraction times under the environment described in Section 3.2.1. Request timing included reading the complete response body, and sampled Node process memory was recorded. Section 3.2.3 states the small dataset and measurement limits. These observations do not establish production capacity, phone response time, or the number of concurrent users the system can support.

Interaction Capability was checked through automated browser tasks and phone-sized layouts. The interface now uses a shared Staff and Manager Case Sheet, clearer next actions, protected original-bill previews, and a rent-first Tenant home. The updated screens use a consistent cream, mint and dark-green interface with clear navigation labels, illustrated headings and support for reduced motion. Actual-device tasks and participant feedback remain pending.

Reliability checks covered duplicate prevention, repeated intake, retained records after restart, rollback of invalid corrections, and continued processing when an independent job failed. These tests cover the recorded scenarios rather than long-term availability.

Security checks covered selected authentication, role restrictions, record access, and workspace separation. A complete penetration test and legal compliance audit were outside these development checks.

### 3.1.4 Implementation Guide and User Manual

To answer the fourth research question, setup instructions, demonstration procedures, sample bill files, a manual test guide, and a user manual have been prepared. They explain account access, property and billing setup, utility intake, correction handling, rent confirmation, personal utility tracking, and receipt access. The guides cover the shared Case Sheet, recovery controls, and a three-person Staff, Manager, and Tenant walkthrough. Local HTTPS instructions support the controlled demonstration. Preparing these guides does not establish that users have completed the tasks successfully.

## 3.2 Project Testing Results

### 3.2.1 Test Environment

The current development verification was conducted on 28 October 2026 using an Acer TravelMate P215-53 laptop with an Intel Core i5-1135G7 processor at 2.40 GHz, four physical cores, eight logical processors, and approximately 7.78 GiB of system-reported physical memory. The operating system was Windows 11 Pro, 64-bit, version 10.0.26200, build 26200. These specifications describe the current run and are not assumed to describe earlier test runs.

The software environment used Node.js 24.21.0, SQLite 3.53.4, and the existing HTML, CSS, and JavaScript frontend. Automated browser tasks used Playwright 1.64.0 with headless Microsoft Edge 156.0.4314.50. Extraction used PDF.js 6.2.108 and Tesseract.js 6.0.1. The installed

communication packages were MailParser 3.9.38, ImapFlow 1.7.8, Nodemailer 10.1.0, and web-push 3.6.7. Installed versions, source hashes, fixture hashes, individual observations, and procedures are retained in the dated development-evidence file.

The full suite ran one test file at a time. Measurements were collected separately after other automated test jobs finished, and the suite was then rerun after correcting a date-dependent test expectation. Scheduled production processing and external mail or Push delivery were not enabled for the measurements. Normal operating-system background activity was not fully controlled.

The automated runs used disposable portfolios, synthetic test data, and the existing anonymized document fixture where applicable. Mailbox transport was simulated in the relevant automated cases, while supported parsing and OCR were exercised through the actual libraries. The separate fixture comparison contained five bill cases represented by nine files: four synthetic cases and one anonymized actual-layout Meralco case. The earlier controlled Gmail test used a self-addressed synthetic bill and its configured demonstration label. No participant payments or representative field dataset were used.

### 3.2.2 Test Scope

Testing covered utility intake, extraction, account mapping, equal allocation, portal alerts, exception investigation, Staff proposals, Manager decisions, and duplicate prevention. It also covered rent reporting and confirmation, receipt reuse, personal utility tracking, retained records after restart, workspace separation, and responsive browser layouts. Some tests deliberately caused an automatic job to fail to check whether other jobs could continue.

Physical Android access, hotspot behavior, certificate trust, push permission and receipt, live rent-email receipt, representative provider extraction accuracy, and formal user evaluation were not established by the automated run. Security testing covered selected authorization and isolation rules rather than a comprehensive penetration test.

### 3.2.3 Executed Test Cases and Recorded Results

The complete automated run on 28 October 2026 executed 99 tests, with 99 passes and no failures, cancellations, or skips. It took approximately 327 seconds, giving a pass rate of 100 percent for the executed tests. These are development regression results rather than a measure of overall system completion, representative OCR accuracy, or participant acceptance. The dated log is retained with the development evidence.

On 1 November 2026, we completed an additional development security check after adding the Admin read-only workspace view. The final full run passed all 144 tests, with no failures, cancellations, or skips, in about 712 seconds. We checked harmful text in displayed values, quoted input fields, application links, and generated receipts. We also checked that a failed audit write returned no record data, and that parallel requests from two Managers did not duplicate a receipt or apply a correction twice. Four selected tests passed in unchanged source copies and failed when deliberate control bypasses were added to those copies. The working source files were unchanged by these negative checks. These results are separate from the 28 October measurements below. They cover selected development scenarios on one backend, not complete security, distributed operation, actual phone delivery, or participant evaluation. The harmful-input case used controlled OCR output and does not measure OCR accuracy.

On 4 November 2026, we tested the combined interface and system updates. The full automated run passed all 155 tests, with no failures, cancellations or skips, in about 355 seconds. We also checked the syntax of 151 JavaScript files without a failure and refreshed 51 interface screenshots using disposable demonstration records. The run covered the retained Admin read-only view, profile restrictions, both demonstration workspaces, input validation and the existing billing workflow. These are development results for this revision, not actual-phone acceptance, live notification delivery or participant evaluation.

Table 3.1: Summary of Recorded Automated Development Tests

| Test area | Executed scenarios | Recorded result |
|---|---|---|
| Utility intake | Scheduled simulated-mailbox retrieval, actual supported parsing/OCR, verified mapping, equal allocation, and linked portal alerts | Passed in the recorded full suite |
| Exception handling | Staff investigation and proposal, Manager rejection with reason, revision, authorization, stale-context checks, and invalid-change rollback | Passed in the recorded full suite |
| Duplicate prevention | Repeated mailbox identifiers, uploads, and equivalent source copies | Passed; no additional charge in the tested cases |
| Rent and receipts | Tenant report, rejection and resubmission, Manager confirmation, authenticated | Passed in the recorded full suite |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | receipt access, and repeated-confirmation reuse | |
| Personal utility tracking | Tenant-owned marks and separation from provider settlement and rent receipts | Passed in the recorded full suite |
| Persistence and access | Application/database close and reopen, retained sources and records, old-message replay, role restrictions, and workspace separation | Passed in the recorded full suite |
| Interface regression | Recorded role journeys, phone-sized layouts, and page-error checks | Passed in the recorded full suite; actual-device acceptance remains separate |

Table 3.1 groups the scenarios covered by the 28 October 2026 run of 99 tests. The categories describe coverage rather than additional tests. The later runs of 144 and 155 tests are separate revision checkpoints and are not added to the earlier total.

Local response measurements used the authenticated reports-summary endpoint and a disposable file-backed SQLite database containing 4 properties, 4 units, 3 tenants, and 30 bills, with no payments or receipts. After five warm-up requests excluded from the measurements, 50 requests were sent sequentially. A second group used five concurrent request loops, each sending ten requests to the already warmed server. Timing started before each request and ended after the complete response body was read. The 95th percentile used the nearest-rank method.

For the sequential group, the mean response time was 5.23 milliseconds, the median was 4.67 milliseconds, and the 95th percentile was 8.50 milliseconds. For the five-loop group, the corresponding values were 23.29, 23.19, and 32.78 milliseconds. All 100 measured requests returned successful HTTP responses with readable JSON. The maximum sampled memory reading across both groups was approximately 181.90 MiB for the Node evidence process and its in-process server. Memory was sampled every 25 milliseconds and at the start and end of each group; short peaks could have been missed. These results exclude browser and operating-system memory, network travel to a phone, real user interaction, and production-sized data. No performance acceptance threshold or five-user capacity claim is inferred.

The document comparison checked provider, account reference, amount due, due date, billing-period start, and billing-period end. These are six stored values representing the five target field types because the billing period has two boundaries. Six direct-text representations, consisting of four digital PDFs and two email files, matched all 36 expected values. Three OCR representations, consisting of two scanned PDFs and one PNG, matched all 18 expected values. Thus, all 54 compared values matched the fixture records in this pass. File versions of the same bill were not counted as independent samples. The fixture expectations are development references, not an independently collected and manually verified evaluation set.

Observed extraction times ranged from 3.10 milliseconds to 1.74 seconds for direct PDF text extraction and from 0.34 to 15.69 seconds for image or scanned-PDF OCR in this single sequential pass. The first PDF and OCR operations included loading costs, and later OCR inputs reused a worker. Email handling used a different boundary that also included parsing and source processing, so its times were not combined with standalone PDF extraction. These observations explain why scanned documents can require more processing than readable text; they do not establish typical bill-processing time or representative OCR accuracy. Field extraction success also does not establish valid account mapping or billing finalization.

A separate controlled Gmail test on 23 October 2026 used a self-addressed synthetic scanned bill. The message entered the configured demonstration label and was retrieved by the scheduler.

OCR and validation produced two charges of PHP 450.00 from a PHP 900.00 source, due on 29 October 2026. Both assigned Tenant accounts could access their bill and linked portal alert. Repeated synchronization did not create another charge. This result covers one controlled email-intake path. Rent-email sending and Web Push delivery were disabled during that test.

3.2.4 Defects and Issues

The QA records identify an intermittent profile-field reset during a browser task. A delayed response reproduced the issue: the same page rendered again while it was still loading. The application was corrected to reuse the ongoing render for the same account, role, and URL. The targeted regression test and the subsequent full test run passed.

Other application corrections addressed an empty category label on unmapped sources, currency formatting in proposal summaries, and narrow-screen wrapping. Separately, test scripts were updated after the demo-login shortcuts were removed. These script updates were adjustments to the tests rather than additional application defects.

An initial run on 28 October 2026 passed 98 of 99 tests. The remaining browser test assumed that a utility alert would use the current month, although its generated due date had crossed into the following month. The application displayed the due month correctly. The test expectation was corrected to use the fixture’s due month, and an assertion was added for the billing cycle. The targeted journey and the subsequent complete 99-test run passed. This was a test-script correction, not a change to billing behavior. An older timing-record date was also replaced with a current timestamp; its header-only timing was not used for the complete-response measurements reported here.

During the additional account-response check, we found that the older response helper removed the password hash but returned other stored fields without an explicit list. A private synthetic test value appeared in the account listing. We changed the helper to return only the supported public account details and notification preferences, and the relevant checks passed. This finding does not establish that actual credentials were exposed. Account creation, password resets, role

permissions, and stored records were preserved. The security checks also clarified a test that previously assumed every list response was an array; it now checks for either a safe denial or records from the correct workspace.

The interface integration also revealed a mismatch between a demonstration setup that used a text floor label and the updated numeric-floor requirement. We corrected the setup without changing existing records. We added checks for text types and lengths, email format and duplicate account emails, payment references, decimal amounts and notification preferences. A partial preference update now preserves an existing opt-out for settings that were not changed. These checks prevent invalid writes; they do not verify a bank payment or a utility provider settlement.

These role restrictions apply to requests made through the active account. A trusted Admin who can create accounts or reset passwords could use another account, and a person controlling the server files or backups is outside this application-role boundary. Password resets revoke sessions and are audited; later actions are recorded under the account used. Our selected tests do not establish protection from every action by a trusted server operator.

The remaining evaluation gaps are actual-device acceptance, intended-recipient notification delivery, supported provider-email testing, representative extraction measurements, and the adviser-approved user evaluation. The interface redesign is implemented. Encrypted or insufficient sources remain processing limitations that require review and an available supported copy; their presence must not be silently treated as a valid bill.

### 3.2.5 Recommendations and Further Testing

The implemented interface should be checked through the prepared Staff, Manager, and Tenant walkthrough. Actual Android testing should check source review, rent reporting, receipt viewing, personal utility tracking, navigation, long content, keyboard behavior, retry controls, and scroll stability using the trusted HTTPS address. Further refinements should preserve billing calculations and role permissions.

Further testing should verify authorized live rent-email delivery and Web Push on supported devices. Extraction accuracy should be measured using consented, anonymized provider documents and manually checked field values, with direct text extraction and OCR reported separately. Future evaluation should record the hardware, software versions, sample counts, procedure, and failures. Participant selection, questionnaire scoring, and user tasks should follow the adviser-approved evaluation plan.

### 3.2.6 Overall Assessment and Next Steps

The recorded development results support a controlled demonstration of the included workflow. They cover automated regression checks, the known-fixture comparison, bounded local response measurements, and the earlier controlled Gmail-to-Tenant intake path. They do not complete the formal evaluation planned in Chapter II. The system can proceed to the prepared user walkthrough and adviser-reviewed evaluation, with actual-device, provider-format, delivery, and representative extraction results recorded before a final release or study-wide quality conclusion.

# CHAPTER IV

# CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter presents our conclusions and recommendations based on the recorded development findings in Chapter III. The conclusions answer the four research questions in Chapter I in the same order, followed by recommendations for further testing and use of the system. Since formal participant evaluation has not yet been conducted, our conclusions are limited to the implemented functions and the development checks that we have completed.

## 4.1 Conclusions

We developed the system through repeated planning, design, development, testing and review using the Iterative Software Development Methodology. The seven development areas described in Chapter III connected account access, property setup, utility intake, validation, billing, payment records and notifications. This process allowed us to check added functions with the existing workflow and correct the issues found during development.

We integrated direct text extraction and OCR with rule-based validation, classification, equal allocation, exception handling and Tenant access in one property-management workflow. Valid utility sources proceed through the defined rules, while unresolved sources require Staff investigation and, when needed, Manager correction or authorization before billing can continue. Rent confirmation and receipts remain Manager-controlled, personal utility marks do not verify provider payment, and portal alerts, Web Push and supplementary rent email support access to the resulting records.

Our development checks provided evidence related to Functional Suitability, Performance Efficiency, Interaction Capability, Reliability and Security through function tests, local response measurements, browser tasks, recovery checks and access-control tests. The combined interface and system run on 4 November 2026 passed all 155 tests, while the earlier extraction comparisons and response measurements remained limited to their stated fixtures and local environment. These findings support a controlled demonstration, but they do not establish

representative OCR accuracy, actual-phone notification delivery, participant acceptance or an overall ISO quality rating.

We prepared an implementation guide and user manual covering setup, account access, utility intake, correction handling, rent confirmation, personal utility tracking, receipts and permitted notifications. The materials also include demonstration files and a walkthrough for Staff, Manager and Tenant tasks, with Admin inspection checks recorded separately. These guides provide instructions for the included workflow, although their clarity and usefulness still need to be checked through actual user tasks.

### 4.2 Recommendations

Our recommendations are derived from the recorded development tests and technical limitations presented in Chapter III. They are not based on completed surveys, stakeholder interviews or participant ratings.

Our development team, together with the assigned Manager, Staff and Tenant testers, should first complete the prepared walkthrough on actual Android phones. Each task should record the device, tester, date, expected result and actual result, including navigation, forms, original-bill review, rent reporting and receipt viewing. The team should correct observed failures and repeat the affected tasks before using the demonstration results as evidence of actual-device operation.

Our development team and the property Manager should test supported provider emails and documents using consented samples with independently checked account references, amounts, dates and billing periods. The checks should cover automatic Gmail labelling, correct workspace and Tenant assignment, repeated retrieval and sources that must remain under review, including incomplete references and unsupported encrypted files. Direct text extraction and OCR results should be recorded separately, without counting copied or edited versions as independent real bills.

Our development team and the agreed Tenant test recipients should verify live rent-email and Web Push delivery using fresh, clearly identified test events. The checks should confirm actual receipt

and access to the correct authenticated record, rather than treating a sending-service acceptance as proof of delivery or reading. The team should also check the existing reminder rules and preserve the restriction that supplementary email applies to rent only.

Our Admins and property Managers should follow the documented account, workspace and backup procedures when preparing the system for actual use. They should check role assignments and utility mappings, keep demonstration records separate from operational records, and verify a restore in a separate directory before relying on a backup. The operating guide should explain the running-backend requirement, same-network access in the local setup, trusted HTTPS configuration, and internet access for Gmail and external notifications; access from other networks must be configured and tested separately.

Our group, with our research adviser, should complete the evaluation plan for the five selected software-quality characteristics and collect the required participant results. The evaluation should use approved tasks, participants and scoring procedures, with actual observations kept separate from automated development tests. We should then update Chapters III and IV with those findings before making a study-wide conclusion about software quality and user acceptance.

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